

BKM 4 Enrichment

E1. Christopher Columbus: “From my first youth onward I was a seaman and have so continued until this day The Lord was well disposed to my desire, and He bestowed upon me courage and understanding; knowledge of seafaring He gave me in abundance, of astrology as much as was needed, and of geometry and astronomy likewise. Further, he gave me joy and cunning in drawing maps and thereon cities, mountains, rivers, islands, and harbours, each one in its place. I have seen and truly I have studied all books—cosmographies, histories, chronicles, and philosophies, and other arts, for which our Lord unlocked my mind, sent me upon the sea, and gave me fire for the deed. Those who heard of my emprise called it foolish, mocked me, and laughed. **But who can doubt but that the Holy Ghost inspired me** (Jacob Wasserman, Columbus, on Quixote of the Seas, pp. 19-20, 46. Cited in [Ted L. Gibbons' blog](#)).

E2. William Bradford—Of Plimoth Plantation:

“If ever there was the essential Pilgrim, it is William Bradford. As the perennial governor and mainstay of Plymouth Colony, he more than any other single person made possible the survival of his community...

Bradford was born in 1588 into a farming community in Yorkshire, England, where he began a lifelong process of self-education through rigorous study and reading. **As a teenager he joined a congregation of Separatists—extreme Protestants who believed that they must separate themselves from the Church of England in order to recover the purity of authentic Christianity.** When that congregation moved to Holland to escape official persecution in England, Bradford went with them, supporting himself in Leyden by practicing the trade of a weaver. The following selections from his remarkable history of this group, known ever after as the Pilgrims, tell the rest of his story.

In the Fourth Chapter in Bradford’s history of the Pilgrims, he gave the reasons they decided to go to the Americas in spite of the difficulties. His last reason was significant:

“Lastly (and which was not least), **a great hope and inward zeal they had of laying some good foundation, or at least to make some way thereunto, for the propagating and advancing the gospel of the kingdom of Christ in those remote parts of the world; yea, though they should be but even as stepping-stones unto others for the performing of so great a work.**”

Bradford wrote in the Seventh Chapter in his history, *Of Plimoth Plantation*:

“So being ready to depart, they had a day of solemn humiliation, their pastor taking his text from Ezra 8:21. **And there at the river, by Abava, I proclaimed a fast, that we might humble ourselves before our God, and seek of him a right way for us, and for our children, and for all our substance...** The rest of the time was spent in pouring out praise to the Lord with great fervency, mixed with abundance of tears.” (*The Mayflower*

Papers: Selected Writings of Colonial New England, Edited with an introduction and Notes by Nathaniel Philbrick and Thomas Philbrick (New York: Penguin Classics, 2007)

E3. John Robinson—the Pilgrim’s pastor who remained in Leyden, Netherlands.

Professor Neil Flinders wrote of their departure:

“At the time of their departure, the 21st of July 1620, from Holland to London, a day of prayer and fasting was held. The conclusion of Mr. Robinson’s counsel was reported by Mr. Winslow. Their faithful teacher who remained behind to care for those not leaving in the initial company charged the group before God and Angels **‘to follow him no further than he followed Christ; and if God should reveal anything to us by any other instrument of his, to be as ready to receive it, as ever we were to receive any truth by his ministry; for he was very confident the Lord had more truth and light yet to break forth of his holy word.’**[4 William B. Sprague, *Annals of the American Pulpit*, 1857.]

“Once again John Robinson displayed his inspired leadership. In a letter from him read to the company on their departure from London on August 5th, 1620, he counseled his comrades and their families.

“1. Daily renew your repentance. This will give you security and peace in danger, comfort in distress, and a happy deliverance from evil whether you live or die.

“2. After making this peace with God and your conscience, carefully provide for peace with your fellowmen. In order to do this you will need to be watchful that you do not easily give or take offence. This will require wisdom, charity and brotherly forbearance.

“3. Focus your purposes and feelings upon the general good, avoiding as a deadly plague personal advantages that are a detriment to the common good. Exercise self discipline.

“4. As you organize yourselves into a body politic exercise wisdom and godliness by selecting leaders who will love and promote the common good. Honor and obey their lawful administrations. Look beyond their personal weaknesses and recognize the good they do as the will of God.[6 V.M. Hall, *William Bradford’s History* (1901 edition) quoted in *Christian History of the Constitution*, p. 185.]]”

“He concluded by reminding them that he prayed daily for the Lord to guide and guard their ways inwardly by the Spirit and outwardly from the elements by his hand of power.

“From Puritans to Separatists to Pilgrims; through conversion, persecution, exile and exodus **traveled the body which became the moral foundation for America.** Progress has a pattern.” (Neil J. Flinders, “The Pattern of Progress,” an academic paper.)

“a book”: “We should not therefore be surprised if, in the investigations that follow, **religion** seems to figure in as somewhat haphazard a and occasional. ... **It registered largely as a kind of underlying presence, part of the very**

atmosphere ... There were, however, clear symbols of its importance: the Bible treasured in nearly every home (including many where no other book was found)".

(John Demos, *A Little Commonwealth: Family Life in Plymouth Colony*, (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1970); John Demos is a professor of history. See Binder #4.)

E4. "Church of the Devil" by B.H. Roberts: "The church of the devil" here alluded to I understand to mean not any particular church among men, or any one sect of religion, but something larger than that—something worldwide—something that includes within its boundaries all evil wherever it may be found; as well in schools of philosophy as in Christian sects; as well in systems of ethics as in systems of religion—something that includes the whole empire of Satan—what I shall call "The Kingdom of Evil."

This descriptive phrase, "the church of the devil," is also used in the Book of Mormon; and while in attendance at a conference in one of the border stakes of Zion, a question was propounded to me in relation to its meaning. The passage occurs in the writings of first Nephi. An angel of the Lord is represented as saying to Nephi, "Behold there are save two churches only: the one is the church of the Lamb of God, and the other is the church of the devil." The question submitted to me was, "Is the Catholic church the church here referred to—the church of the devil?" "Well," said I, in answer, "I would not like to take that position, because it would leave me with a lot of churches on my hands that I might not then be able to classify." So far as the Catholic church is concerned, I believe that there is just as much truth, nay, personally I believe it has retained even more truth than other divisions of so-called Christendom; and there is just as much virtue, and I am sure there is more strength in the Roman Catholic church than there is in Protestant Christendom.

I would not like, therefore, to designate the Catholic church [*sic*] as the church of the devil. Neither would I like to designate any one or all of the various divisions and subdivisions of Protestant Christendom combined as such church; nor the Greek Catholic church; nor the Buddhist sects; nor the followers of Confucius; nor the followers of Mohammed; nor would I like to designate even the societies formed by deists and atheists as constituting the church of the devil. The Book of Mormon text ought to be read in connection with its context—with the chapter that precedes it and the remaining portions of the chapter in which it is found—then, I think, those who study it in that manner will be forced to the conclusion that the Prophet here has in mind no particular church, no particular division of Christendom, but he has in mind, as just stated, the whole empire of Satan; and perhaps the thought of the passage would be more nearly expressed if we use the term "the kingdom of evil" as constituting the church of the devil.

I understand the injunction to Oliver Cowdery to "contend against no church, save it be the church of the devil," to mean that he shall contend against evil, against untruth, against all combinations of wicked men. They constitute the church of the devil, the kingdom of evil, a federation of unrighteousness; and the servants of God have a right to contend against that which is evil, let it appear where it will, in Catholic or in Protestant Christendom, among the philosophical societies of deists and atheists, and even within the Church of Christ, if, unhappily, it should make its appearance there. But, let it be understood, we are not brought necessarily into antagonism with the various sects of Christianity as such. So far as they have retained fragments of Christian truth—and each of them has some measure of truth—that far they are acceptable unto the Lord; and it would be poor policy for us to contend against them without discrimination. Wherever we find truth, whether it exists in complete form or only in fragments, we recognize that truth as part of that sacred whole of which the Church of Jesus Christ is the custodian; and I repeat that our relationship to the religious world is not one that calls for the denunciation of sectarian churches as composing the church of the devil. All that makes for untruth, for unrighteousness constitutes the kingdom of evil—the church of the devil. All that makes for truth, for righteousness, is of God; it constitutes the kingdom of righteousness—the empire of Jehovah; and, in a certain sense at least, constitutes the Church of Christ. With the latter—the kingdom of righteousness—we have no warfare. On the contrary both the spirit of the Lord's commandments to His servants and the dictates of right reason would suggest that we seek to enlarge this kingdom of righteousness both by recognizing such truths as it possesses and seeking the friendship and co-operation of the righteous men and women who constitute its membership. ([Conference Report, Friday, April 6, 1906](#), Afternoon Session, pp. 13-17.)

E5. Church: "The term *church* (Hebrew *qahal* or *edah*; Greek *ekklesia*) had a slightly broader meaning anciently than it does now and referred to an assembly, congregation, or association of people which bonded them together and commanded their loyalties. Thus the term was not necessarily restricted to religious associations and, in fact, at Athens was used to denote the legislative assembly of government.[3] When we put all this together it appears that the phrase *great and abominable church* means an immense assembly or association of people bound together by their loyalty to that which God hates." Stephen E. Robinson, *The Book of Mormon: First Nephi, The Doctrinal Foundation*, p. 178; cited in Brad Constantine's Lesson 4 Blog at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#). Select 2016 BofM. Select (4 1 Nephi 12-14. Select Brad Constantine GD lesson material)

E11. Additional Teaching Ideas (from Lesson #1)

2. Sharing the Book of Mormon

“Consult with the bishopric and the ward mission leader about how members can obtain copies of the Book of Mormon to share with nonmember friends and acquaintances.

“In class, suggest that a class goal this year should be to share the Book of Mormon with nonmember friends and acquaintances. Explain to class members how they may obtain copies of the Book of Mormon, and encourage each class member to give a copy to at least one friend or acquaintance during the year.

“Several times during the year, as the Spirit directs, ask class members if any of them have yet shared a copy of the Book of Mormon. Invite class members who have done this to briefly describe the experience. Continue to encourage class members to share the Book of Mormon with others.” (*Lesson Manual*)

Recommended Reading and Viewing Resources:

Ensign Articles of Importance:

1. President Ezra Taft Benson, “[The Book of Mormon—Keystone of our Religion](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1986.
2. Boyd K. Packer, “[The Book of Mormon: Another Testament of Jesus Christ—Plain and Precious Things](#),” *Ensign*, May 2005, 6-9.
3. President Marion G. Romney, “[The Book of Mormon](#),” *Ensign*, May 1980, 67).
4. James A. Cullimore (Assistant to the Twelve), “[The Book of Mormon](#),” *Ensign*, May 1976.

Scholarly Resources of Interest:

1. [Book of Mormon Central.org](#).
2. [2016 Gospel Doctrine—Recommended Resources on the Book of Mormon \(updated\)](#), Ben S., Times and Seasons, December 19, 2015.
3. “[Complexity, Consistency, Ignorance, and Probabilities](#),” Melvin J. Thorne, *Book of Mormon Authorship: Revisited*, Chapter 7.
4. BYU Studies Quarterly, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#), Select 2016 BofM. Select **4**) 1 Nephi 12-14. Select BYU Studies GD lesson material.
5. “[The Plain and Precious Parts](#),” John Welch, Chapter 10 in *Reexploring the Book of Mormon*, pp. 37-40.

Blogs of Interest:

1. Nancy Jensen, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#), Select 2016 BofM. Select **4**) 1 Nephi 12-14. Select Nancy Jensen Gospel Doctrine lesson material blog “LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus”.
2. Gerald Smith, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#), Select 2016 BofM. Select **4**) 1 Nephi 12-14. Select Gerald Smith Gospel Doctrine lesson blog “Joel’s Monastery”.
3. Lenet H. Read, at [LDSGospelDoctrine.net](#), Select 2016 BofM. Select **4**) 1 Nephi 12-14. Select Lenet Read GD lessons.

Non-Mormon Views of Mormons:

1. Stephen H. Webb, “[Mormonism obsessed with Christ](#),” First Things, accessed 1/16/16.

When you read this article by a former evangelical Christian who converted to Catholicism, Ponderize the BKM 3 Quotes: **†1** and **†2** with it. Stephen H. Webb is professor of religion and philosophy at Wabash College.

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